Decent Coaching Classes

X Nisha

Academic Conquest - VIII

Subject: English – 1.1 A Teenager's Prayer, 1.2 An Encounter of a Special Kind

Time: 1 Hour **Marks: 30**

Instructions: *(1) All questions are compulsory. (2) Marks are shown on the right. (3) Write the answers neatly in your answer sheet.*

Q.1 Read the extract and complete the activities. **8**

Without losing any time, I gathered a stout stick in one hand and hurled a piece of stone at the marauding langur. The langur was so infuriated that it hardly took any notice of my assault. But then I started throwing more stones. The dogs on their part raised their pitch of cry. The changed circumstances and the sudden unexpected attack from unknown quarters forced the langur to drop the baby from the sloping roof over the veranda. The baby was listless and appeared to be dead. As its body started to slide down, the excitement of the pack of dogs grew manifold at the prospect of a good kill and meal. Keeping the dogs at bay with the stick, I managed to catch hold of the baby langur's tail just as it tipped over the edge of the tiled roof. The baby appeared inert and lifeless. It was indeed a male baby.

(A1) Choose the correct alternative and complete the sentences. [2]

(a) The langur dropped the baby because ..... .

(a) it was tired (b) it wanted to fight the dogs (c) the sudden attack from unknown quarters forced it

(b) The excitement of the dogs grew manifold because ..... .

(a) they saw the prospect of a good kill and meal (b) the narrator called them (c) they wanted to play with the baby

(A2) Answer the following questions in one sentence each. [2]

(a) What did the narrator use to keep the dogs at bay?

(b) How did the narrator save the baby langur from falling?

(A3) Personal response. [2]

What opinion do you form about the narrator from his act? Write in 2–3 sentences.

(A4) Find words from the extract which mean the following. [2]

(a) without any energy .....

(b) attack .....

Q.2 Read the poem 'A Teenager's Prayer' and complete the activities. **6**

Each day brings new beginnings, *Decisions I must make.* *I am the only one to choose* *The road that I will take.* *I can choose to take the road of life,* *That leads to great success* *Or travel down the darkened road,* *That leads to great distress.* *Please open up my eyes, dear Lord,* *That I might clearly see* *Help me stand for what is right,* *Bring out the best in me.*	*Help, Lord, to just say "no"* *When temptation comes my way,* *That I might keep my body clean* *And fit for life each day.* *When my teenage years are over,* *I know that I will see* *That life is lived its very best* *With you walking next to me.*

(A1) Complete the following sentences with the help of the poem. [2]

(a) The poet prays to the Lord to help him say "no" when ..... comes his way.

(b) The poet wants to keep his body ..... and fit for life each day.

(A2) Poetic devices. [2]

(a) What is the rhyme scheme of the first stanza? (aabb / abcb / abba)

(b) Name the figure of speech used in: 'Please open up my eyes, dear Lord'.

(A3) Theme. [2]

What does the poet pray for in this poem? Write in 2–3 sentences.

Q.3 Match the phrases in Group 'A' with their meanings in Group 'B'. (One meaning in Group 'B' is extra.) **4**

Group 'A'	**Group 'B'**
(a) part and parcel of	(i) very quickly
(b) engrossed in	(ii) to observe and give attention
(c) take notice of	(iii) completely occupied in
(d) in a flash	(iv) an essential or integral part of
	(v) to find comfort and peace

Q.4 Language Study. **4**

(A) Rewrite as instructed. [2]

(1) The narrator saved the baby langur. (Change the voice.)

(2) He said, "I will help the injured bird." (Change into indirect speech.)

(B) Identify the figure of speech in each sentence. [2]

(1) The baby was trembling like a leaf in the wind.

(2) Books! You are my best friends.

Q.5 Writing Skill. (Any one) **8**

(A) Write a paragraph in about 10–12 sentences and give it an appropriate title. Use the following points: Birds and animals – loyal – serve us – our best friends – love and affection – kindness and compassion – protection and security – do not hurt or destroy them.

(B) Write an appreciation of the poem 'A Teenager's Prayer' in about 10–12 sentences, with the help of these points: title, poet, rhyme scheme, favourite line, theme/central idea, figures of speech, why I like the poem.

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